

AGENDA:

- 1. Ratings of each paper**
- 2. Verdict on which topic to work**
- 3. Which topics to study to gather knowledge**
- 4. What kind of softwares to use and their skill levels**
- 5. Fix an assignment topic to give to our teammates to check their level of commitment.**

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List of papers reviewed

- a) A MOSFET SPICE Model With Integrated Electro-Thermal Averaged Modeling, Aging, and Lifetime Estimation, doi: 10.1109/ACCESS.2020.3047110
- b) AQuasi-Floating Channel-Based SPICE Model for Improving the Modeling Accuracy of SiC MOSFETs With Multiple Device Structures, doi: 10.1109/TPEL.2024.3433370
- c) JFET and MOSFET SPICE Models in a Wide Temperature Range, DOI: 10.1134/S1063739721070064
- d) Physics-Based PiN Diode SPICE Model for Power-Circuit Simulation, doi: 10.1109/TIA.2007.900492
- e) A Flexible, Physically based SPICE Model for the JFET Resistance in Silicon Carbide and Super-Junction MOSFETs
- f) Electro-Thermal Modeling of SiC Power Devices for Circuit Simulation, doi: 10.1109/IECON.2013.6699223.
- g) RCFilter Design for Wireless Power Transfer: AFourier Series Approach, doi: 10.1109/LSP.2022.3148673
- h) SPICE Analysis of RL and RC Snubber Circuits for Synchronous Buck DC-DC Converters, doi: 10.1109/MIPRO.2015.7160245
- i) High Precision I-V Characteristics SPICE Model for Silicon Carbide MOSFET, DOI: 10.1109

Analysis of the Research Papers

Topic Categories

1. **Power Electronics:** The papers address power MOSFET technologies, specifically SiC and Super-Junction MOSFETs, which are critical for efficient power conversion.
2. **Semiconductor Device Modeling:** Few papers propose a physically based SPICE model to simulate the JFET region resistance, accounting for nonlinear effects like junction depletion and velocity saturation.
3. **Circuit Simulation:** The model is designed to be SPICE-agnostic, enabling accurate simulation of conduction losses and other figures of merit like Short Circuit Withstand Time.
4. **Material Science:** The paper discusses SiC, a wide-bandgap material, and its advantages over silicon in power applications.

Problems Addressed

- **Inaccurate Modeling of JFET Region Resistance:** Existing models use simple linear resistors, failing to capture nonlinear effects in the JFET region, which contributes significantly to total on-resistance (25% for SiC MOSFETs, 69% for Super-Junction MOSFETs).
- **Conduction Loss Simulation:** Accurate modeling of JFET resistance is crucial for simulating conduction losses in power electronic applications.
- **Nonlinear Effects in Drift Region:** Previous models have limitations in capturing nonlinear effects like junction depletion and velocity saturation, impacting simulation accuracy for high-voltage and high-current scenarios.
- **Application-Specific Performance:** The model addresses critical metrics like Short Circuit Withstand Time, essential for applications such as traction inverters.

Table of Resources and Knowledge Pools

Resource (Software)	Description	Knowledge Pools Required
SPICE (e.g., LTspice, PSpice)	Circuit simulation software for modeling MOSFET behavior and validating the proposed JFET resistance model.	Semiconductor physics, circuit analysis, SPICE modeling, MOSFET operation principles.
MATLAB/Simulink	Used for numerical analysis and validation of model equations, particularly for nonlinear effects.	Numerical methods, semiconductor device physics, data analysis, control systems.
TCAD (e.g., Silvaco, Synopsys)	Technology Computer-Aided Design for simulating semiconductor device structures and validating physical models.	Semiconductor fabrication, device physics, TCAD simulation techniques, material science (SiC).
Cadence Virtuoso	Potential use for integrated circuit design and SPICE model integration.	IC design, SPICE model implementation, analog circuit simulation.

Topic Selection

Based on the criteria (completion within 6 months, software simulation feasibility, and available knowledge), the topic of **A Quasi-Floating Channel-Based SPICE Model for Improving the Modeling Accuracy of SiC MOSFETs With Multiple Device Structures** is recommended.

This choice is justified because:

1. **Completion within 6 Months:** The research focuses on specific components and leverages existing SPICE frameworks, making it achievable with focused effort.
2. **Software Simulation Feasibility:** SPICE and MATLAB are accessible and widely used for circuit and numerical simulations, respectively. TCAD can be optional for deeper physical validation.
3. **Available Knowledge:** Semiconductor physics, MOSFET operation, and SPICE modeling are well-documented fields, with ample resources available for learning.

Roadmap for Research

Knowledge Fields to Study

1. **Semiconductor Physics:**
 - **Key Concepts:** Understand carrier transport, junction depletion, velocity saturation, and wide-bandgap materials (e.g., SiC). Study how these affect JFET region resistance.
 - **Resources:** "Semiconductor Device Physics" by Sze and Ng, online courses (e.g., Coursera's "Introduction to Power Electronics").
 - **Timeline:** 1 month for basics, focusing on MOSFET operation and SiC properties.
2. **Power Electronics:**
 - **Key Concepts:** Learn about power MOSFET applications, conduction losses, and figures of merit like $R_{DS(on)}$ and Short Circuit Withstand Time.
 - **Resources:** "Fundamentals of Power Electronics" by Erickson and Maksimović, IEEE Power Electronics Society webinars.
 - **Timeline:** 1 month, parallel with semiconductor physics, focusing on MOSFET applications.
3. **SPICE Modeling:**
 - **Key Concepts:** Master SPICE syntax, subcircuit modeling, and parameter extraction for MOSFETs. Understand how to implement nonlinear models.

- **Resources:** LTspice tutorials, "SPICE for Power Electronics and Electric Power" by Rashid.
 - **Timeline:** 1.5 months, including hands-on practice with SPICE simulations.
4. **Numerical Analysis (MATLAB):**
- **Key Concepts:** Use MATLAB for solving equations related to JFET current and validating model accuracy against experimental data.
 - **Resources:** MATLAB documentation, "Numerical Methods for Engineers" by Chapra and Canale.
 - **Timeline:** 1 month, overlapping with SPICE modeling, focusing on scripting and data analysis.

Software to Learn

To research the topic "A Quasi-Floating Channel-Based SPICE Model for Improving the Modeling Accuracy of SiC MOSFETs with Multiple Device Structures," the following software tools are essential for developing, simulating, and validating the proposed SPICE model:

1. LTspice:

- **Purpose:** Simulate the quasi-floating channel-based SPICE model for SiC MOSFETs, capturing the behavior of multiple device structures and their electrical characteristics.
- **Learning Path:** Begin with LTspice tutorials on YouTube (e.g., Analog Devices channel) to understand netlist creation and simulation. Practice building MOSFET subcircuits and simulating I-V and C-V characteristics.
- **Timeline:** 1 month to achieve proficiency in creating and simulating complex SPICE models.
- **Resources:** LTspice official website, user forums, and "SPICE for Power Electronics and Electric Power" by Rashid.

2. MATLAB:

- **Purpose:** Analyze and validate the SPICE model by fitting simulation data to theoretical equations, particularly for quasi-floating channel effects and device parameter extraction.
- **Learning Path:** Complete MATLAB Onramp (free course on MathWorks) and practice scripting for semiconductor equations. Use MATLAB to model channel resistance and capacitance behavior.
- **Timeline:** 1 month for basic proficiency, focusing on numerical analysis and data fitting.

- **Resources:** MathWorks tutorials, MATLAB Central community.

3. **TCAD (Optional, e.g., Silvaco or Synopsys):**

- **Purpose:** Simulate physical SiC MOSFET device structures to validate the quasi-floating channel model parameters, ensuring physical accuracy.
- **Learning Path:** Study TCAD tutorials focusing on SiC MOSFET simulations, including doping profiles and channel effects.
- **Timeline:** 1 month for basic understanding, if pursued.
- **Resources:** Silvaco or Synopsys documentation, university access to TCAD tools.